

VOLTR

VOLTR PROGRAM

Athletic Strength

8 weeks · 3 sessions per week · 60 to 75 minutes · full gym

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How this program works

THE PLAN

Eight weeks, three sessions a week, 60 to 75 minutes each. Each session starts with power work while you are fresh, then one heavy compound lift, paired accessories, trunk work and a loaded carry. Two blocks: block 1 builds volume, block 2 lowers reps and raises load. Week 1 and week 8 are measured.

WHO IT IS FOR

Adults with one to two years of consistent lifting who want to be strong and athletic at the same time. You squat, hinge and press with solid technique, train in a full gym and commit three sessions a week.

WHO IT IS NOT FOR

Beginners who are still learning the main lifts.
Anyone with a current injury, or a medical condition that has not been cleared for hard training.
Runners building towards a race: use the Hybrid plan.
Weeks where 45 minutes is the honest maximum: use the 3-Day Minimum plan.

EQUIPMENT

Barbell and rack, bench, trap bar, dumbbells, kettlebell, cable station, landmine, plyo box, medicine ball (3 to 6 kg) and a solid wall to throw against. A sled is optional.

THE WEEK

Three sessions in order, A, B, C, ideally with a day off between them. Never A and C back to back, both load the legs and back. Off days: walk, easy cardio or mobility.

HOW TO READ THE SHEET

The spreadsheet has the tabs START HERE (this page), BLOCK 1 (weeks 1 to 4), BLOCK 2 (weeks 5 to 8), LOG.
Each block tab lists the three training days as rows and the four weeks as column groups. Each week has two columns: the target and an empty Load column for you.
Target format: sets x reps @ RIR. 4 × 6 @ RIR 2 means four sets of six reps, each set ending with two reps in reserve. /side means each arm or leg. 3a and 3b are a pair: one set of 3a, rest as listed, one set of 3b, rest as listed, repeat. Take the full rest on main lifts.
Tempo: lowering, pause at the bottom, lifting, pause at the top, in seconds. X means as fast as possible.

RIR AND RPE

RIR means reps in reserve: how many more clean reps you could have done when you end the set. RPE is the same scale counted the other way: RPE 8 equals RIR 2, RPE 9 equals RIR 1.

Choose the load from the target RIR. Most people underestimate what was left by about one rep, more on higher-rep sets. If the last rep moved as fast as the first, add load next time.

PROGRESSION

Main lifts (squat, bench press, trap bar deadlift): linear load progression. Week 1 sets the load. Then add 2.5 to 5 kg on squat and deadlift, 1 to 2.5 kg on bench, each week the previous sets matched the target RIR. If not, repeat the load.

Accessories: double progression. When all sets reach the top of the rep range at the target RIR, add the smallest step and start at the bottom again.

Power work: every rep at maximal intent. End the set when height, distance or speed drops.

Week 4: deload, fewer sets, week-2 loads, RIR 3 to 4. Block 2 starts with roughly your week 3 loads at lower reps. Week 8 is the test: one top set at RPE 9, two back-off sets, top set into the e1RM table on the LOG tab.

WARM-UP

8 to 10 minutes: 3 minutes bike, rower or skipping. 90/90 hip switch x 6 per side, world's greatest stretch x 4 per side, glute bridge x 10, band pull-apart x 15, pogo hops 2 x 10. Then ramp-up sets on the first main lift: empty bar x 8, then three or four sets with falling reps up to the working load. They do not count.

MISSED SESSIONS AND BAD WEEKS

Missed one session: do the next session in order. Never two sessions in one day, never skip ahead.

Missed a full week: repeat the last complete week, then continue.

Bad day (sleep, travel, stress): sets and reps stay as written, the load follows the target RIR. Log it.

Two sessions in a row clearly below previous loads: check sleep, food and workload first, fix the cause, then continue as written.

HOW TO LOG

Write the load in kg into the Load cell after the last working set. Different loads per set: 100, 102.5, 102.5. Reps short of the target: 100 x 5, 5, 4.

Fill in the LOG tab once a week, and the benchmarks in week 1 and week 8.

The log decides next week's load.

Block 1 • weeks 1 to 4 • build

Block 1 builds the volume that block 2 turns into heavier lifting. Each session opens with power work, then one main lift, then accessories, trunk and a carry. Main lifts: add load each week as long as the target RIR holds. Week 4 is the deload: fewer sets, week-2 loads, RIR 3 to 4. Order of sessions: A, B, C.

Day A • Lower + Power

Squat focus, vertical pull, anti-rotation. About 70 minutes.

1 Box jump

Choose a box you land on softly in a quarter to half squat. Step down every rep and reset.

TEMPO X • REST 90 S

WK 1 • BUILD
3 × 3

WK 2 • BUILD
4 × 3

WK 3 • BUILD
4 × 3

WK 4 • DELOAD
2 × 3

2 Back squat

Brace before you unrack. Sit down between the heels, knees track over the toes. Chest and hips rise together.

TEMPO 3-0-X-0 • REST 2-3 MIN

WK 1 • BUILD
4 × 6 @ RIR 3

WK 2 • BUILD
4 × 6 @ RIR 2

WK 3 • BUILD
5 × 5 @ RIR 2

WK 4 • DELOAD
3 × 5 @ RIR 4

3a Bulgarian split squat

Rear foot on a bench, DBs at your sides. Front shin close to vertical at the bottom. Start with the weaker leg.

TEMPO 3-0-1-0 • REST 60 S

WK 1 • BUILD
3 × 8/side @ RIR 3

WK 2 • BUILD
3 × 8/side @ RIR 2

WK 3 • BUILD
3 × 10/side @ RIR 2

WK 4 • DELOAD
2 × 8/side @ RIR 4

3b Chin-up

Full hang to chin over the bar. Ribs down, no swing. Add load once all sets reach 8 clean reps.

TEMPO 2-0-1-1 • REST 90 S

WK 1 • BUILD
4 × 5-8 @ RIR 3

WK 2 • BUILD
4 × 5-8 @ RIR 2

WK 3 • BUILD
4 × 5-8 @ RIR 2

WK 4 • DELOAD
2 × 5 @ RIR 4

4 Nordic hamstring curl

Heels anchored. Lower forward as slowly as you can, catch with the hands, push back up. Use a band for help if needed.

TEMPO SLOW LOWER • REST 90 S

WK 1 • BUILD
2 × 4

WK 2 • BUILD
2 × 5

WK 3 • BUILD
3 × 5

WK 4 • DELOAD
1 × 4

5 Suitcase carry

One heavy DB or kettlebell in one hand. Walk tall, shoulders level, slow steps. Add load each week.

REST 60 S

WK 1 • BUILD
3 × 30 m/side

WK 2 • BUILD
3 × 30 m/side

WK 3 • BUILD
4 × 30 m/side

WK 4 • DELOAD
2 × 30 m/side

Day B • Upper + Rotation

Horizontal press, rows, rotational power. About 65 minutes.

1 Med-ball rotational scoop toss

Side-on to a wall, 3 to 6 kg ball. Load the back hip, then throw: hips first, arms last. Catch and reset.

TEMPO X • REST 60 S

WK 1 • BUILD
3 × 4/side

WK 2 • BUILD
3 × 5/side

WK 3 • BUILD
4 × 5/side

WK 4 • DELOAD
2 × 4/side

2 Bench press

Shoulder blades pulled together, feet planted. Touch the lower chest, pause 1 s, press.

TEMPO 2-1-X-0 • REST 2-3 MIN

WK 1 • BUILD
4 × 6 @ RIR 3

WK 2 • BUILD
4 × 6 @ RIR 2

WK 3 • BUILD
5 × 5 @ RIR 2

WK 4 • DELOAD
3 × 5 @ RIR 4

3a Chest-supported DB row

Chest on an incline bench at 30 to 45 degrees. Pull the elbows towards the hips, pause at the top.

TEMPO 2-0-1-1 • REST 60 S

WK 1 • BUILD
4 × 8-10 @ RIR 3

WK 2 • BUILD
4 × 8-10 @ RIR 2

WK 3 • BUILD
4 × 8-10 @ RIR 2

WK 4 • DELOAD
2 × 8 @ RIR 4

3b Half-kneeling landmine press

Down on the knee of the pressing side. Squeeze that glute, press up and slightly forward.

TEMPO 2-0-1-0 • REST 90 S

WK 1 • BUILD
3 × 8/side @ RIR 3

WK 2 • BUILD
3 × 8/side @ RIR 2

WK 3 • BUILD
3 × 10/side @ RIR 2

WK 4 • DELOAD
2 × 8/side @ RIR 4

4 Incline DB press

Bench at 30 degrees. Lower to the outside of the chest, elbows about 45 degrees from the body.

TEMPO 3-0-1-0 • REST 90 S

WK 1 • BUILD
3 × 8-12 @ RIR 3

WK 2 • BUILD
3 × 8-12 @ RIR 2

WK 3 • BUILD
3 × 8-12 @ RIR 2

WK 4 • DELOAD
2 × 8 @ RIR 4

5a Cable face pull

Rope at eye height. Pull towards the forehead, elbows high, hands finish beside the ears.

TEMPO 2-0-1-1 · REST 0 S

WK 1 · BUILD
3 × 12-15

WK 2 · BUILD
3 × 12-15

WK 3 · BUILD
3 × 12-15

WK 4 · DELOAD
2 × 12

5b Dead bug

Lower back stays on the floor the whole set. Exhale fully while the arm and opposite leg extend.

TEMPO SLOW · REST 60 S

WK 1 · BUILD
3 × 6/side

WK 2 · BUILD
3 × 6/side

WK 3 · BUILD
3 × 8/side

WK 4 · DELOAD
2 × 6/side

Day C · Hinge + Carry

Deadlift focus, posterior chain, adductors, loaded carries. About 70 minutes.

1 Kettlebell swing

Hike the bell high between the legs, snap the hips. Arms only guide. The bell floats to chest height.

TEMPO X · REST 60 S

WK 1 · BUILD
4 × 8

WK 2 · BUILD
4 × 10

WK 3 · BUILD
5 × 10

WK 4 · DELOAD
3 × 8

2 Trap bar deadlift

Handles in line with the middle of the foot. Push the floor away, stand tall, lower under control. Reset each rep.

TEMPO 2-0-X-0 · REST 2-3 MIN

WK 1 · BUILD
4 × 5 @ RIR 3

WK 2 · BUILD
4 × 5 @ RIR 2

WK 3 · BUILD
5 × 4 @ RIR 2

WK 4 · DELOAD
3 × 4 @ RIR 4

3a Romanian deadlift

Soft knees, hips back until the hamstrings stretch, bar close to the legs. Stop before the lower back rounds.

TEMPO 3-0-1-0 · REST 60 S

WK 1 · BUILD
3 × 8 @ RIR 3

WK 2 · BUILD
3 × 8 @ RIR 2

WK 3 · BUILD
3 × 8 @ RIR 2

WK 4 · DELOAD
2 × 8 @ RIR 4

3b Single-arm cable row

Half-kneeling or split stance. Reach long, then row to the hip without twisting.

TEMPO 2-0-1-1 · REST 90 S

WK 1 · BUILD
3 × 10/side @ RIR 3

WK 2 · BUILD
3 × 10/side @ RIR 2

WK 3 · BUILD
3 × 10/side @ RIR 2

WK 4 · DELOAD
2 × 10/side @ RIR 4

4 **Copenhagen plank, short lever**

Knee on the bench, bottom leg free. Hips high, one line from shoulder to knee.

TEMPO HOLD • REST 45 S

WK 1 • BUILD
3 × 15 s/side

WK 2 • BUILD
3 × 20 s/side

WK 3 • BUILD
3 × 25 s/side

WK 4 • DELOAD
2 × 15 s/side

5 **Farmer carry**

Heaviest pair you can carry without the posture breaking. Short, quick steps, eyes ahead.

REST 90 S

WK 1 • BUILD
4 × 30 m

WK 2 • BUILD
4 × 30 m

WK 3 • BUILD
4 × 40 m

WK 4 • DELOAD
2 × 30 m

6 **Sled push (if available)**

Low body angle, drive through the whole foot. No sled: heavy farmer carry instead, same sets.

REST 90 S

WK 1 • BUILD
4 × 15 m

WK 2 • BUILD
4 × 15 m

WK 3 • BUILD
5 × 15 m

WK 4 • DELOAD
Off

Block 2 · weeks 5 to 8 · intensify + test

Block 2 keeps the three main lifts and moves to lower reps and heavier loads. Power work and several accessories change. Start week 5 on the main lifts with roughly your week 3 loads. Week 8 is the test: build to one top set at RPE 9, then two back-off sets at RIR 3. Write the top sets into the benchmarks on the LOG tab.

Day A · Lower + Power

Heavier squat, weighted pull, rotation. About 70 minutes.

1 Standing broad jump

Swing the arms, jump as far as you can, stick the landing for 2 s. Walk back, reset.

TEMPO X · REST 90 S

WK 5 · INTENSIFY
4 × 2

WK 6 · INTENSIFY
5 × 2

WK 7 · PEAK
5 × 2

WK 8 · TEST
3 × 2

2 Back squat

Same setup as block 1. Heavier loads, same depth. Every rep to the same standard.

TEMPO 2-0-X-0 · REST 3 MIN

WK 5 · INTENSIFY
4 × 4 @ RIR 2

WK 6 · INTENSIFY
5 × 4 @ RIR 2

WK 7 · PEAK
4 × 3 @ RIR 1

WK 8 · TEST
Top set 1 × 2 @ RPE 9,
then 2 × 4 @ RIR 3

3a Front-foot elevated reverse lunge

Front foot on a 5 to 10 cm plate. Step back, knee lightly to the floor, drive up through the front foot.

TEMPO 2-0-1-0 · REST 60 S

WK 5 · INTENSIFY
3 × 6/side @ RIR 2

WK 6 · INTENSIFY
3 × 6/side @ RIR 2

WK 7 · PEAK
3 × 6/side @ RIR 1

WK 8 · TEST
2 × 6/side @ RIR 3

3b Weighted chin-up

Load with a belt or a DB between the feet. Same standard: full hang, chin over the bar. Fewer than 5 strict reps: stay at bodyweight and add reps.

TEMPO 2-0-1-0 · REST 90 S

WK 5 · INTENSIFY
4 × 4-6 @ RIR 2

WK 6 · INTENSIFY
4 × 4-6 @ RIR 2

WK 7 · PEAK
4 × 4-6 @ RIR 1

WK 8 · TEST
2 × 4 @ RIR 3

4 Half-kneeling cable lift

Cable low on the side of the down knee. Pull up and across from hip to opposite shoulder, hips stay square.

TEMPO CONTROLLED · REST 45 S

WK 5 · INTENSIFY
3 × 8/side

WK 6 · INTENSIFY
3 × 8/side

WK 7 · PEAK
3 × 10/side

WK 8 · TEST
2 × 8/side

5 Suitcase carry

Heavier than block 1, shorter distance. Shoulders stay level.

REST 60 S

WK 5 • INTENSIFY
3 × 20 m/side

WK 6 • INTENSIFY
3 × 20 m/side

WK 7 • PEAK
4 × 20 m/side

WK 8 • TEST
2 × 20 m/side

Day B • Upper + Rotation

Heavier press, barbell row, explosive pressing. About 65 minutes.

1 Med-ball rotational shot put

Ball at the back shoulder, side-on to the wall. Drive from the back leg, push the ball through with the palm.

TEMPO X • REST 60 S

WK 5 • INTENSIFY
4 × 3/side

WK 6 • INTENSIFY
4 × 3/side

WK 7 • PEAK
5 × 3/side

WK 8 • TEST
3 × 3/side

2 Bench press

Same setup as block 1. Pause 1 s on the chest on every rep, including the top set.

TEMPO 2-1-X-0 • REST 3 MIN

WK 5 • INTENSIFY
4 × 4 @ RIR 2

WK 6 • INTENSIFY
5 × 4 @ RIR 2

WK 7 • PEAK
4 × 3 @ RIR 1

WK 8 • TEST
Top set 1 × 2 @ RPE 9,
then 2 × 4 @ RIR 3

3a Barbell bent-over row

Hinge to about 45 degrees, bar to the lower ribs, torso still. Lower under control.

TEMPO 2-0-1-1 • REST 60 S

WK 5 • INTENSIFY
4 × 6 @ RIR 2

WK 6 • INTENSIFY
4 × 6 @ RIR 2

WK 7 • PEAK
4 × 6 @ RIR 1

WK 8 • TEST
2 × 6 @ RIR 3

3b Landmine push press

Standing. Short dip with the legs, then press hard. One arm at a time.

TEMPO X • REST 90 S

WK 5 • INTENSIFY
3 × 5/side

WK 6 • INTENSIFY
3 × 5/side

WK 7 • PEAK
4 × 5/side

WK 8 • TEST
2 × 5/side

4 Weighted push-up

Plate on the upper back or a band across it. Body moves as one piece, chest to a fist-height target.

TEMPO 2-0-1-0 • REST 90 S

WK 5 • INTENSIFY
3 × 8-12 @ RIR 2

WK 6 • INTENSIFY
3 × 8-12 @ RIR 2

WK 7 • PEAK
3 × 8-12 @ RIR 1

WK 8 • TEST
2 × 8 @ RIR 3

5a Cable face pull

Rope at eye height, elbows high, hands finish beside the ears.

TEMPO 2-0-1-1 · REST 0 S

WK 5 · INTENSIFY
3 × 12-15

WK 6 · INTENSIFY
3 × 12-15

WK 7 · PEAK
3 × 12-15

WK 8 · TEST
2 × 12

5b Ab wheel rollout

From the knees. Roll out only as far as the lower back stays flat. Pull back with the abs.

TEMPO 3-0-1-0 · REST 60 S

WK 5 · INTENSIFY
3 × 6-10

WK 6 · INTENSIFY
3 × 6-10

WK 7 · PEAK
3 × 8-12

WK 8 · TEST
2 × 6

Day C · Hinge + Carry

Heavier deadlift, single-leg hinge, heavier carries. About 70 minutes.

1 Trap bar jump

Light trap bar, 20 to 30 percent of your deadlift working load. Dip and jump, land softly, reset each rep.

TEMPO X · REST 90 S

WK 5 · INTENSIFY
4 × 3

WK 6 · INTENSIFY
4 × 3

WK 7 · PEAK
5 × 3

WK 8 · TEST
3 × 3

2 Trap bar deadlift

Same setup as block 1. Reset each rep. On the top set, no grinding past RPE 9.

TEMPO 2-0-X-0 · REST 3 MIN

WK 5 · INTENSIFY
4 × 3 @ RIR 2

WK 6 · INTENSIFY
5 × 3 @ RIR 2

WK 7 · PEAK
4 × 2 @ RIR 1

WK 8 · TEST
Top set 1 × 2 @ RPE 9,
then 2 × 3 @ RIR 3

3a Single-leg RDL

DB in the hand opposite the standing leg. Hips square to the floor, reach the DB towards the floor.

TEMPO 3-0-1-0 · REST 60 S

WK 5 · INTENSIFY
3 × 8/side @ RIR 2

WK 6 · INTENSIFY
3 × 8/side @ RIR 2

WK 7 · PEAK
3 × 8/side @ RIR 1

WK 8 · TEST
2 × 8/side @ RIR 3

3b Single-arm cable row

Same as block 1. Heavier, same strict form.

TEMPO 2-0-1-1 · REST 90 S

WK 5 · INTENSIFY
3 × 8/side @ RIR 2

WK 6 · INTENSIFY
3 × 8/side @ RIR 2

WK 7 · PEAK
3 × 8/side @ RIR 1

WK 8 · TEST
2 × 8/side @ RIR 3

4 **Copenhagen plank, long lever**

Inside of the ankle on the bench. Move here only if the short lever held 25 s with good position. If not, stay short.

TEMPO HOLD · REST 45 S

WK 5 · INTENSIFY
3 × 15 s/side

WK 6 · INTENSIFY
3 × 20 s/side

WK 7 · PEAK
3 × 20 s/side

WK 8 · TEST
2 × 15 s/side

5 **Farmer carry**

Heavier than block 1, shorter distance.

REST 90 S

WK 5 · INTENSIFY
4 × 20 m

WK 6 · INTENSIFY
4 × 20 m

WK 7 · PEAK
4 × 30 m

WK 8 · TEST
2 × 20 m

6 **Sled push (if available)**

Heavier sled than block 1. No sled: heavy farmer carry instead, same sets.

REST 90 S

WK 5 · INTENSIFY
5 × 15 m

WK 6 · INTENSIFY
5 × 15 m

WK 7 · PEAK
6 × 15 m

WK 8 · TEST
Off

V O L T R

NEXT STEP

Want it built around your weeks?

This program is written for most weeks. 1:1 coaching builds your training around your schedule, travel and history, and adjusts it every week.

Book a free 30-minute call: voltr.at/#book